

ing software, and then recompress them to smaller file sizes if required. Here are some of the more popular video codecs.

2.3.1 AVI

Strictly speaking, AVI (Audio Video Interleave) is not a codec, but rather, a container framework. This means that AVI can “contain” other video codecs. This is one of the oldest video container formats and supports nearly all available video codecs. In fact, when Windows transfers the DV data from a MiniDV tape, the DV codec is contained within the AVI format.

There are many technical disadvantages with AVI, and many consider it to be an outdated format, especially for distribution. However, there is strong support for this format especially in file sharing communities due to its compatibility with Windows Media Player.

2.3.2 ASF

Similar to AVI, ASF (Advanced Systems Format) is a container format that be encoded with virtually any of the available video codecs. Both AVI and ASF are proprietary to Microsoft, and ASF is positioned as the successor to AVI. ASF is ideal for streaming video.

2.3.3 QuickTime (MOV)

Again, MOV, or QuickTime, is a multimedia container format that can contain specific codecs including the DV codec. QuickTime in many ways is a superior format compared to many other containers due to its ability to separate the audio / video data from metadata such as track lists, subtitles, etc. This makes it very amenable to editing. It also supports in-place editing (that is, without copying) of various other formats such as DV, MPEG-1, and AVI. To create QuickTime movies, however, you will need the QuickTime Pro video editing software. .Mov files, though, can be played using the QuickTime Player, which is available as a free download.